



Digital Wellness in an Online World



Categories: [Health](#)

August 31st, 2022

Chat with
World Campus
(requires login)

Some days it can feel like you spend your entire life staring at a screen. Work, social media, gaming, TV, and movies — technology has made all of these easily accessible, which can make it difficult

to detach and can have negative effects on our physical and mental health.

Spending too much time staring at a screen can lead to vision and lower back problems, as well as increased feelings of loneliness and isolation. As online learners at Penn State World Campus, it's especially important to be proactive in preventing these issues.

Digital wellness refers to finding a healthy and intentional relationship with technology, in all aspects of life. So how can you improve your digital wellness when you need to be online?

Give your body a break

Five-minute breaks every hour can do wonders for your overall productivity. Look away from the screen and focus on something in the distance, and if possible, walk to another room or move your body to get your blood flowing.

Be proactive about your time online

Because you already spend a lot of time online for classes, try to set certain times of the day to check email and social media. Instead of picking up your phone countless times throughout the day, set designated times to catch up. Check out our [Time Management Calculator](#) to get an idea of what your week might look like depending on the number of credits you take.

Manage the content you consume

It's easy to fall into negative habits, and surrounding yourself with negativity — online or in real life — will take a toll on your mental health. Consider unfollowing or muting accounts that impact you negatively, and keep in mind that most people only post their best moments, so don't compare your life to their curated content.

You can avoid mindlessly scrolling your feed while waiting in line or at an appointment by planning ahead and having ebooks or magazines on your phone instead.

Chat with
World Campus
(requires login)

Calm your mind

Take longer breaks when transitioning from work to school. Go outside if you can — [nature can provide a calmness](#) that can increase well-being and decrease anxiety. [Read about mental health resources](#) available to Penn State World Campus students.

Use technology for good

Turn off or customize push notifications and use your devices' Do Not Disturb features.

Download apps that help set boundaries, such as reminders to stop using screens before bedtime. And if you have a lot of reading to do for class but need a break from staring at a screen, switch to audio. Some e-reader apps will [read the text aloud](#) so you can rest your eyes or listen while outside on a walk.

Incorporating these tips into your daily digital consumption can help you feel more engaged and can lead to a more balanced physical and mental well-being.

Other helpful resources

For more on digital wellness, visit these resources:

[Penn State Student Affairs: Relaxation Room](#)

[Penn State University Libraries: Digital Wellness Workshop](#)



PennState
World Campus

Chaiken Center for Student Success

[Finances](#)

[Inclusion and Wellness](#)

Chat with
World Campus
(requires login)



Enrollment and Registration



Course Work and Success



Involvement and Opportunities



[A-Z Index](#) • [About](#) • [Blog](#) • [Calendar](#) • [Help and Support](#)

Information for:

[New and Recently Admitted Students](#) • [Returning Students](#) • [Graduating Students](#) •

[Military Students](#)

 814-865-5403

 info@worldcampus.psu.edu

The Pennsylvania State University
128 Outreach Innovation Building
100 Innovation Blvd.
University Park, PA 16802



PennState

[Accessibility](#) • [Consumer Information and Disclosures](#) • [Nondiscrimination](#) • [Privacy](#)

The Pennsylvania State University © 2026

Chat with
World Campus
(requires login)